

Gemini Smith (she/her)

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Senior Software Engineer · Test Automation and Backend Systems

Software engineer with 8+ years across test automation, DevOps, and backend development. Started in test at Brightcove, as sole automation owner for server-side ad insertion and builder of its cross-device video testing, then built the Cypress and CircleCI test platform at Freshly. Cucumber open source contributor, CircleCI guest author, and founder of the Phoenix chapter of Ministry of Testing. The same habit carries into backend work: find the real root cause and ship a fix that holds up in production. Self-taught.

EXPERIENCE

Gametime · Backend Software Engineer (IC2), Supply Squad

Remote · 09/2023 – 09/2025

- **Sole author of the Ticketmaster manifest ingestion subsystem** (~1,600 lines of Go): normalization, two-tier validation, event and venue matching across every MLB team and season type, and delivery to Ticketmaster's API. Built alone over ~5 months and supported live through the MLB playoffs.
- Root-caused a data-integrity bug where listings existed in MongoDB with no matching PostgreSQL row, leaving unsellable inventory live and causing customer refunds. Added graceful shutdown to the CSV parser and extended an internal reconciliation tool to detect and repair orphaned records: **947 and 21,737 listings fixed** across two suppliers.
- Designed a file-hashing dedupe at the FTP ingress layer so repeated supplier CSV uploads were no longer fully re-parsed. Pitched it at a hackathon; it didn't place, but shipped to production weeks later, **cutting parsing jobs ~30%** and ending the ingest backlogs that had let stale listings sell.

Syndio · Software Engineer (Backend)

Remote · 11/2021 – 05/2023

- Asked to stub an API for the frontend team; built mocked APIs with controllable, URL-encoded response behavior plus a test suite that doubled as the backend contract spec. **One piece of work unblocked two teams in parallel.**
- Self-initiated investigation into a company-wide ephemeral-environment outage that had every engineer and QA person hitting silent failures. Root-caused it to NGINX response-header size limits; it never recurred.
- Owned the permissions/RBAC domain for a pay-equity platform serving Fortune 500 employers. Designed a YAML-defined role model code-generated into both Go and Python so the two runtimes couldn't drift.

Freshly · DevOps Engineer, L2+

Remote · 12/2020 – 11/2021

- **Designed, scoped, and built an automated failover system** protecting the homepage, the entry point to a \$430M revenue funnel, from third-party CMS outages. Reroutes traffic via Istio on failure and reverts on recovery; 88.9% core test coverage.
- Executed the 1.27B+ row production PostgreSQL migration from Heroku to GCP via Striim CDC with **zero downtime and zero post-migration fixes.**

Freshly · Test Automation Engineer, L2

Remote · 08/2019 – 12/2020

- **Built and scaled an automated testing platform** on Cypress and CircleCI; established testing practices adopted team-wide.
- Wrote and open sourced a Ruby gem enabling remote state manipulation between Cypress (or any test framework) and a Rails app.
- Led the CI migration from Semaphore to CircleCI, reducing test execution time and improving developer workflow.

Brightcove · Senior Software Engineer in Test / Software Engineer (Backend)

Scottsdale, AZ · 11/2016 – 08/2019

- **Sole owner of test automation** for the Server Side Video and Ad Insertion product, supporting a global team of 12+ Go engineers.
- **Built cross-device video playback testing** with Selenium and Appium on BrowserStack and Sauce Labs device farms, and managed the Sauce Labs vendor relationship. A web player streamed a test video with a per-second QR timecode; screenshots taken every second verified that the player, device, and video all showed the same time.
- Built, unprompted, a configurable ad server on AWS Lambda and DynamoDB as test infrastructure: variable-length creatives, placement control, trackable playback URLs, and VAST, SmartXML/Freewheel, and Google DFP formats from one parameter-driven URL. **Adopted company-wide, including sales demos; still in production 6+ years after departure.**
- Backend Go engineer on the APIs behind the company's video ingest platform.

COMMUNITY AND OPEN SOURCE

- **Ministry of Testing, Phoenix:** founded and ran the local chapter for a year, organizing and hosting its meetups.
- **Open source:** contributor to Cucumber (Ruby and Go); guest author for the Cucumber blog and CircleCI (three articles, two adopted into official CircleCI docs).
- **Speaking:** Desert Code Camp (“Communication for the Benefit of All”); Phoenix Golang meetup (testing, lightning talks).
- **Freelance:** Cucumber Ltd; TDD consulting for Gistic Research Ltd; QA for Drone Racing League's racing simulator.

SKILLS

Test automation: Cypress, Selenium, Appium, Cucumber (BDD), TDD · **Device and browser clouds:** BrowserStack, Sauce Labs
Languages: Go, Ruby, Python, JavaScript · **Data:** PostgreSQL, MongoDB, DynamoDB, Redis
Infrastructure and CI/CD: CircleCI, Kubernetes, Docker, Istio, Terraform, GCP, AWS, Datadog